2008 Toyota Prius Touring (hybrid)

$7,999 · 150,000 miles · Dealer · Rosamond, CA

Seller: Rosamond Auto Sales, 2609 Sierra Hwy, Rosamond

Source: Craigslist

Listing: https://www.craigslist.org/view/d/lancaster-2008-toyota-prius-touring/hQhXS5AiyFJtKtMj3cwFwJ

Report generated October 31, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 4 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$9,104	**$467**	**Average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	3/5 · 4 recalls · 1,497 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$7,999.00
Sales tax (9.25%)	$739.91
Dealer doc + filing fees	$125.00
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$51.99
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$9,103.90
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$4,103.90
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$82.23
Total interest over the loan	$830.12
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$82.23
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 46 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$103.26
Maintenance & repair reserve	$130.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$16.83
Total per month	$467.33

Running costs without the loan: **$385/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$14,159** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: typical car. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Average (3/5)

The 2nd-gen Prius is one of the most reliable cars ever built, but this one is 18 years old: the main risk is the hybrid battery (a refurbished pack is roughly $1,500-3,000) and other age-related hybrid parts.

NHTSA data for this model year: 4 recalls · 1,497 owner complaints (152 involving a crash). Most complaints: Exterior Lighting (579), Service Brakes (395), Electrical System (235), Hydraulic (171), Vehicle Speed Control (156), Electric (77).

Known issues for this model

• Hybrid battery capacity loss with age

• Brake actuator / ABS pump failure (expensive)

• Combination meter (dash display) failure

• Some 1.5L engines burn oil; EGR clogging at high miles

Check on this car before buying

• Hybrid battery health test at an independent hybrid shop (worth paying for)

• No warning lights (triangle / ABS / check engine)

• Dash display works

• Ask the dealer what the 3-day return terms are (CARS Act)

Notes

$7,999, 150k mi. Clean title, 'just passed California emission test', backup camera, GPS, trade-in. Dealer listing on Craigslist.

Best fuel economy of anything in range: ~48 city MPG - roughly half the gas of a Camry.

~1.5 hr drive from Ridgecrest (CA-14). Confirm availability by phone/text before driving.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.